

The price is determined the way stock prices might be, based on the currency's popularity. The *New York Times* described Bitcoin in a 2017 article, "What Is Bitcoin and How Does It Work?" saying the "system is run by a decentralized network of computers around the world keeping track of all Bitcoin transactions, similar to the way Wikipedia is maintained by a decentralized network of writers and editors."

I invested \$505 in Litecoin using a digital wallet called Coinbase. I track my investment using the Coinbase app. I'm telling you this as if I understand any of it. I don't. At the time when I bought two Litecoins, Bitcoin had shot up to be worth \$14,000 for one Bitcoin. (Bitcoin had had a moment a few years before, and then people largely forgot about it. Suddenly cryptocurrency was back in the limelight.)

Litecoin is my first crypto-investment. I thought it was a semi-safe place to start. Investing is like gambling. If I lose, the money is only money I am okay losing anyway. If I make even a little money, then I'll be pleasantly surprised.

Comedian Samantha Ruddy had bought Bitcoin back when it was hot and forgot about it. She tweeted in 2018 that she checked her investment for the first time around the same time I bought Litecoin and found she'd made \$700 she didn't previously know about. TechCrunch writer Taylor Hatmaker even created a Google Doc-based cryptocurrency guide specifically for queer people to encourage investing among minorities. (It's a thorough ten-page document that notes that while capitalism is bad, Hatmaker would rather minorities benefit from it if the system has to exist. Go look for her work if you're interested!)

Investing in cryptocurrency is complicated because investing in general is complicated. On my show, I interviewed Sallie Krawcheck, who survived working on Wall Street in the 1980s, a brutally hostile male environment. (She told me she often found photocopies of "male nether regions" on her desk.)

Like Hatmaker, Krawcheck advised marginalized people of all kinds who can afford to invest to start doing so. Ellevest works with stocks, which she describes very patiently for me as "ownership in a company . . . and a company's earnings." It helps a company raise money to grow the company. Here's what I learned from talking to her: